

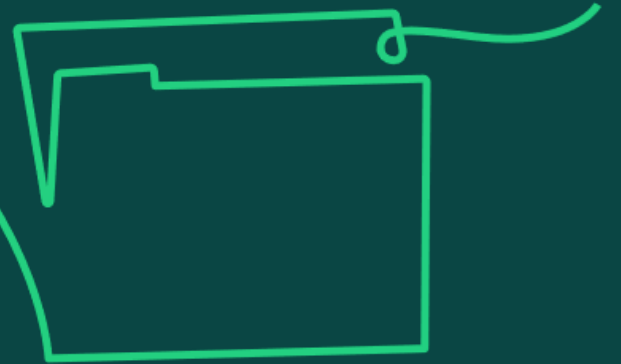
Version #	Date	Details of change	Page / slide no.

Assurance

Learning objective:

7) Understand assurance as the ability to provide confidence to the governance board that a project is on track to deliver objectives.

7a) Know the purpose of assurance within a project; including awareness of the scope, priorities and strategic aims of assurance activities.



Assurance reviews

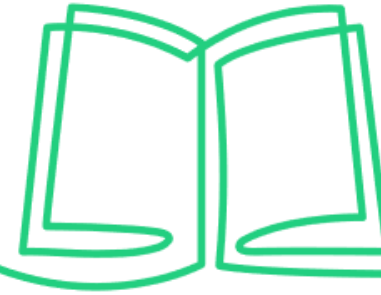
- Objective and independent approach agreed by sponsor and other stakeholders.
- Provide confidence to the governance board the project is on track.
- Support decision making and change control.
- Improve risk assessment.
- Increase probability of projects meeting their objectives.

Assurance activities within a project and priorities



These work together: any weakness in one discipline damages all three.

Assurance activities



1. Set Controls

- Application of a management system, comprising policies, procedures, processes, standards.
- Intended outcome is to control risks.

2. Ensure Compliance

- Management assurance, comprising monitoring, checks and audits through risk management, quality assurance, PMOs.
- Intended outcome is to confirm the control of risks.

3. Independent review

- Assurance through independent reviews by internal audit, external audit (e.g. NAO), independent peers or external scrutiny.
- Intended outcome is to provide strategic overview of system of control.

A successful assurance plan will meet certain criteria

Assurance is independent, objective and proportionate to the work.

Assurance is targeted where the greatest risks exist.

There are clear accountabilities for assurance arrangements, activities and outputs.

Timings and cycles of assurance activities are planned and coordinated.

The governance route for reporting outcomes and resolving issues is clear.